

Advertisement

HARDWARE



India's richest man wants
to turn every TV into a PC

Need Help?

Check the FAQs for common questions.
Send 'JioCloud PC' as a WhatsApp message to
+91 8010434343 for support.

[Browse FAQs](#)

Quick Tour

This quick tour will give key features of
your new age PC and help you get
started.

[Quick tour](#)

Jio Platforms, the digital arm of Indian conglomerate Reliance Industries, has [launched](#) a virtual desktop service for set-top box users. This means that India's richest man, Reliance's chairman Mukesh Ambani, hopes to turn millions of TVs in the world's most populous country into PCs.

Called [JioPC](#), the service offers a cloud-based PC experience through Jio's set-top box, which comes bundled for free with the telco's home broadband service or can be purchased separately for ₹5,499 (\$64). Currently in free trial and available via waitlist, users can access the virtual desktop on their TV by plugging in a keyboard and mouse once they receive an invite and set up their account.

At present, the service has some limitations, including no support for external peripherals, such as cameras and printers. Similarly, it supports open source LibreOffice, which is pre-installed. To use Microsoft Office apps, users need to access them via the available browser.

That said, Ambani's move with JioPC looks promising — at least on paper.

Tarun Pathak, a research director at Counterpoint, told TechCrunch that JioPC is a very effective way for the Mumbai-headquartered company to increase its user base, which already has [over 488 million users](#).

TEC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government's website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

Around 70% of Indian households have a TV, but only 15% of them own a PC, per Pathak. But Jio Platforms could have its hands full with marketing and explanations. “You need to convince people that you can still use a PC on your TV using the set-top box,” he stated.

India’s active pay-TV set-top box user base stands at [nearly 57 million](#), per government data. However, the traditional direct-to-home (DTH) TV market is shrinking as more consumers shift to internet-based services. As of March, the active DTH subscriber base had declined by 8% year-over-year, the data shows.

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren’t even dating apps

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

Prabhu Ram, vice president of the Industry Research Group (IRG) at CyberMedia Research (CMR), said with JioPC, Jio could onboard new set-top box users from underpenetrated rural and low-income segments.

“While its potential reach is broad, its success will depend on execution — especially in addressing

connectivity gaps and digital literacy — and on its ability to scale beyond early adopters to effectively serve underserved communities,” he noted.

In Q1, India’s overall PC market experienced [over 8% year-over-year growth](#) in shipments, reaching 3.3 million units — marking the seventh consecutive quarter of growth, per IDC. However, PC penetration in the country remains relatively low, [lagging behind key markets](#), including the U.S. and China, mainly due to limited disposable income and the widespread use of smartphones as primary computing devices.

Pathak stated that for Jio to reach potential PC buyers with JioPC, it would require partnerships with several app developers and productivity solution providers and ensure it has enough productivity apps to make the service valuable for consumers.

Companies including [Microsoft](#) and many other cloud providers have offered virtual desktop services targeting enterprise customers for some time. However, Jio’s move represents the first serious consumer-oriented move, Ram said.

Topics: [Gadgets](#) [Hardware](#) [India](#) [jio](#) [Jio Platforms](#)

[JioPC](#) [reliance](#) [reliance jio](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [reddit](#) [email](#) [link](#)



Jagmeet Singh

Reporter | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [M](#) [in](#)

Jagmeet covers startups, tech policy-related updates, and all other major tech-centric developments from India for...

[View Bio](#) >



IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [reddit](#) [email](#) [link](#)

Google and Jio delay their India smartphone launch

Manish Singh — 12:52 PM PDT · September 9, 2021

The JioPhone Next, the [much-awaited smartphone](#) designed by Google and India's Jio Platforms to tap hundreds of millions of users in the world's second-largest internet market, won't launch on Friday, the Indian technology giant said Thursday midnight.

In a statement issued just now, Jio Platforms said it has been testing the smartphone with a "limited set of users for further refinement" and is "actively working to make it available more widely" around the time of Diwali festival, which is scheduled for early November.

Newsletters

[See More ↗](#)

Subscribe for the industry's biggest tech news

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch's coverage.

Google and India’s Jio Platforms announce budget Android smartphone JioPhone Next



Jio Platforms, run by India’s richest man (Mukesh Ambani), and Google on Thursday unveiled the JioPhone Next, an affordable Android smartphone, as the top Indian telecom operator and the American giant make further push to expand their reach in the world’s second-largest internet market. The Indian firm, which secured \$4.5 billion investment from Google (and [Continue reading](#)

Startups Weekly

Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review

Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility

TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

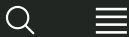
The Indian firm, which operates the largest telecom network with over 400 million subscribers, blamed global semiconductor shortages for the launch delay and said it expects the additional two months

No newsletters selected.

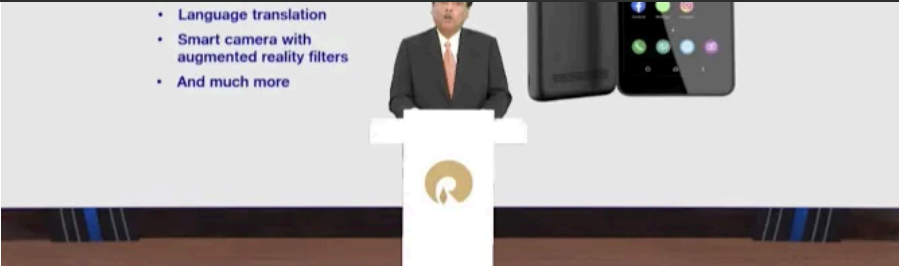
Email address

By submitting your email, you

- Latest
- Security
- Startups
- AI
- Venture
- Apps
- Apple



- Events
- Podcasts
- Newsletters



MUKESH AMBANI, INDIA’S RICHEST MAN AND THE CHAIRMAN OF RELIANCE INDUSTRIES, WHICH OPERATES JIO PLATFORMS, UNVEILING JIOPHONE NEXT AT AN EVENT IN JUNE THIS YEAR

IMAGE CREDITS: JIO PLATFORMS

Powered by “extremely optimized Android” mobile operating system, the JioPhone Next phone is marketed to be an “ultra-affordable 4G smartphone” to tap the roughly 300 million users in India who are still on slower networks. The two firms have said that they plan to eventually launch the smartphone in other markets as well.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

[REGISTER NOW](#)

At an event in June, the two firms said the JioPhone Next will feature a “fast, high-quality camera” which will support HDR, and will be protected by the latest Android releases and security updates. It will also ship with a range of features, including Read Aloud and Translate Now that will work with any text on the phone screen, including web pages, apps, messages and even photos, the two firms have said.

Analysts have said in recent weeks that the JioPhone Next — whose price and tech specifications are yet to be revealed — could disrupt the Indian smartphone market — the world’s second largest — and help the telecom network further solidify its dominance in the country.

“At present, there are 430 million smartphone users, 115 million JioPhone users [Jio’s “smart” featurephone] and 320 million featurephone (2G) users in India. We believe smartphone users with devices priced above \$100 are unlikely to opt for a sub \$100 device,” analysts at Jefferies wrote in a report to clients this week. “That leaves 25% of smartphone users, i.e. 105 million smartphones, 115 million JioPhone users and 320 million featurephone users as the addressable market for JioPhone Next. Assuming replacement cycle of 2 years for smartphones and 3 years for JioPhone/featurephones, the addressable market for JioPhone Next could be 200m devices annually.”

The smartphone is the latest collaboration between the two firms. Last year, Google invested [\\$4.5 billion in Jio Platforms](#) and that’s where it first announced the plans to develop cheap smartphones with the Indian telecom operator. Facebook and scores of other firms have also bought stakes in the Indian firm. Jio Platforms operates a number of businesses, including telecom giant Jio Infocomm, which competes with Airtel and Vodafone Idea; and e-commerce firm JioMart, which competes with Tata-owned BigBasket, SoftBank-backed Grofers and Amazon and Walmart’s Flipkart.

Topics: [Android](#) [Asia](#) [Google](#) [Hardware](#)

[Jio Platforms](#) [reliance](#) [reliance jio](#)

[smartphones](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [📧](#) [✉](#)



Manish Singh

Reporter, India | [X](#) [in](#)

Manish Singh is a senior reporter at TechCrunch, covering India's startup scene and venture capital investments. He...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING

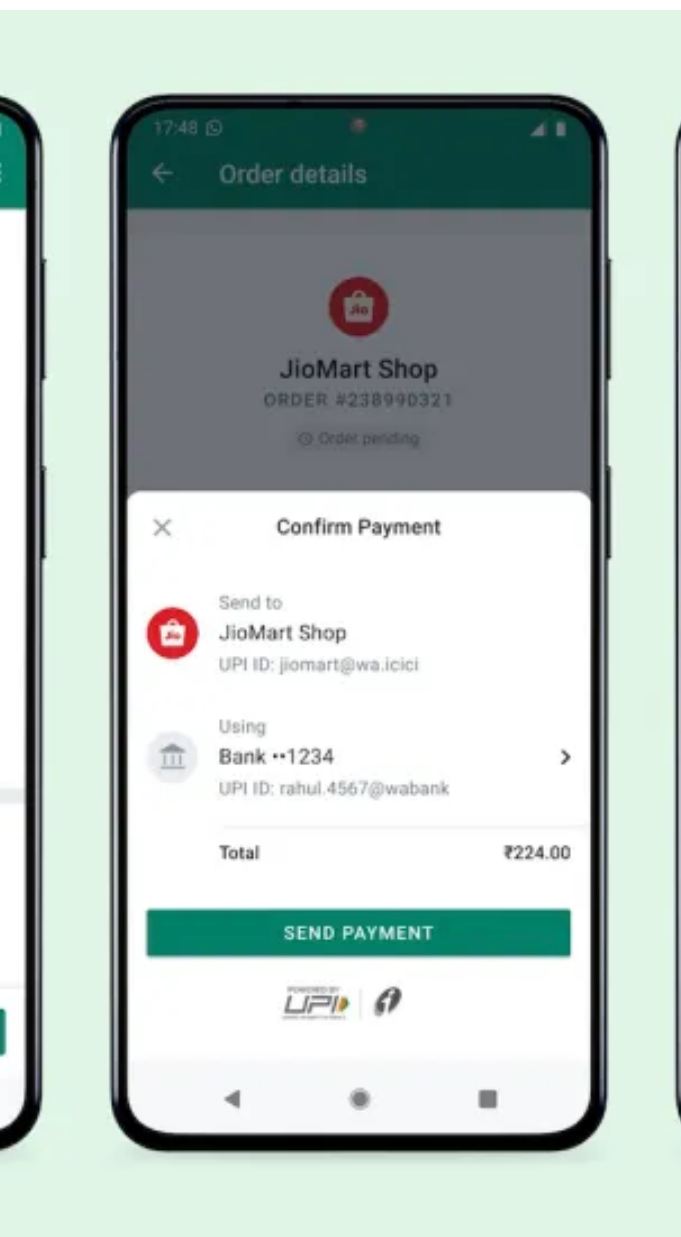


IMAGE CREDITS: WHATSAPP

Meta and Jio launch grocery shopping on WhatsApp in India

Manish Singh, Jagmeet Singh

2:45 AM PDT · August 29, 2022

Meta and an e-commerce venture between India's Reliance Retail and Jio Platforms are bringing grocery shopping to WhatsApp in what they said was a global-first end-to-end shopping experience on the popular instant messaging platform.

Advertisement

The launch of JioMart on WhatsApp follows Meta and JioMart beginning to [test an integration with select users two years ago](#). If successful, a commerce engine could prove to be a major source of revenue for WhatsApp, which has largely avoided serving ads to app users.

Customers in India will be able to browse JioMart's entire grocery catalog on WhatsApp, add items to a cart and make the payments via local payments rail UPI without ever leaving the instant messaging service, the companies said.

WhatsApp, which is used by about half a billion Indians each month, got the approval to extend its UPI-powered payments service to [100 million users in the country](#) earlier this year after several delays and setbacks.

"Excited to launch our partnership with JioMart in India. This is our first-ever end-to-end shopping experience on WhatsApp — people can now buy groceries from JioMart right in a chat. Business messaging is an area with real momentum and chat-based experiences like this will be the go-to way people and businesses communicate in the years to come," Mark Zuckerberg, CEO of Meta, said in a statement.

Meta is a significant minority investor in Jio Platforms, the country's largest telecom subscriber with over 421 million subscribers. On Monday, Jio also announced it will be spending \$25 billion to debut 5G services in the country in October this year and [aims to reach "every town" in the South Asian market by end of next year](#).

[Facebook invests \\$5.7B in India's Reliance Jio Platforms](#)

Latest in Apps

[See More](#)

APPS



The Browser Company launches a \$20 monthly subscription for its AI-powered browser

Ivan Mehta - 4 hours ago

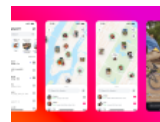
AI



Google takes on ChatGPT's Study Mode with new 'Guided Learning' tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik - 17 hours ago

APPS



Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'

Aisha Malik - 21 hours ago

Advertisement

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

JioMart is the \$221 billion Indian conglomerate's attempt at taking on Amazon and Flipkart in India. Ambani's Reliance Retail is the largest retail chain in the country, but currently it has limited e-commerce offerings.

In a speech years ago, Ambani, an ally of India's Prime Minister Narendra Modi, invoked Mahatma Gandhi and said, like Gandhi, who led a movement against political colonization of India, "we have to collectively launch a new movement against data colonization. For India to succeed in this data-driven revolution, we will have to migrate the control and ownership of Indian data back to India — in other words, Indian wealth back to every Indian."

At the company's general meeting, Ambani said Zuckerberg shares his vision of bringing more people and businesses online and creating "truly innovative solutions that will add convenience to the daily lives of every Indian."

"One example of an innovative customer experience that we are proud of developing is the first ever end-to-end shopping experience with JioMart on WhatsApp." Ambani said. "The JioMart

on WhatsApp experience furthers our commitment of enabling a simple and convenient way of online shopping to millions of Indians.”

Topics: [Apps](#) [Asia](#) [Asia](#) [Commerce](#) [India](#) [India](#)

[Jio Platforms](#) [jiomart](#) [reliance jio](#) [WhatsApp](#)

Advertisement



Manish Singh

Reporter, India | [X](#) [in](#)

Manish Singh is a senior reporter at TechCrunch, covering India’s startup scene and venture capital investments. He...

[View Bio](#) >



Jagmeet Singh

Reporter | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Jagmeet covers startups, tech policy-related updates, and all other major tech-centric developments from India for...

[View Bio](#) >

Loading the next article





[TechCrunch Staff](#)

[Contact Us](#)

[Advertise](#)

[Crunchboard Jobs](#)

[Site Map](#)

[Terms of Service](#)

[Privacy Policy](#)

[RSS Terms of Use](#)

[OpenAI](#)

[Perplexity](#)

[Cisco](#)

[DeepMind](#)

[Windsurf](#)

[Tech Layoffs](#)

[ChatGPT](#)